

*Robuchon
au
Dôme*

天巢法國餐廳



DAVID SHAW
MAY 21ST, 2021

MENU SIGNATURE

Les plats emblématiques de Joël Robuchon

Le King Crabe

Alaskan king crab, delicate vegetable and ginger jelly with cream Vichyssoise
阿拉斯加帝王蟹佐精緻蔬菜嫩姜凍及維希濃湯

Le Caviar de Sologne

Impérial caviar and king crab refreshed with crustacean jelly
法國魚子醬伴海鮮凍及椰菜花忌廉

~

La Morille

Morel mushroom with comté cheese ravioli and fried suckling pig skin
法國摩利菌芝士雲吞佐炸脆乳豬皮

~

La Saint-Jacques

Pan seared scallops, coconut and fresh coriander
香煎日本帶子配椰子香草泡沫

~

Le Homard Cardinalisé

Roasted lobster with salted butter, stewed green peas and spicy bisque sauce
香烤龍蝦伴青豆配龍蝦濃湯

~

Le Bœuf Wagyu

Grilled Wagyu beef with shallot and red wine purée, parsley purée
Served with seasonal salad, pomme soufflé, and chicken bouillon
香烤和牛配香蔥紅酒醬及歐芹醬，伴薯仔梳乎厘，時蔬沙拉，和雞肉清湯

~

Les Fromages de Nos Régions

Brillat-Savarin, 36-Month-Aged Comté, Valençay
精選法國芝士 - 布里亞-薩瓦蘭奶酪，36月陈年孔泰奶酪，法隆塞山羊奶酪

La Manguue

Mango sugar sphere with old rum ice cream, light coconut foam
芒果糖球伴蘭姆酒雪糕及椰子慕斯

~

La Symphonie des Douceurs

Dessert trolley - mille-feuille, religieuse, île flottante, et rum baba
精選甜品車 - 法式千層酥，修女泡芙，漂浮島，蘭姆巴巴

~

La Glace et le Sorbet

Ice cream trolley - strawberry, passionfruit, coconut
精選冰淇淋車 - 草莓，百香果，以及椰子冰淇淋

Le Thé et la Mignardise

Earl grey tea, papaya tart, lemon bonbon, et earl grey bonbon
伯爵茶伴精美糖果 - 木瓜撻，檸檬巧克力，伯爵茶巧克力



Together with Restaurant Joël Robuchon Las Vegas and Ebisu, Robuchon au Dôme is one of the three haute gastronomic restaurants of the legendary chef Joël Robuchon that features his most prestige creations. Due to the pandemic, Robuchon au Dôme is only operating three lunches per week. I personally prefer lunchtime as I enjoy the bright natural light shining through the gorgeous dome and being reflected by the luxurious chandelier.

Our lunch degustation journey unfolds on their prestige trolley experience. A champagne trolley appears right in front of us, what could be better than a glass of champagne in the summertime? I picked Taittinger's prestige Comtes de Champagne 2008, what an elegant blanc de blancs! Then as I'm still gazing at the vivid effervescence trying to escape, a bread trolley arrives at our table. With so many gorgeous baked goods right in front of our eyes, we simply hope to taste each of them, but our calm minds remind us that there is still a gargantuan gastronomic experience waiting for us. We eventually get to try focaccia and pain d'epi, and without surprise, they turn out to be heavenly superb.



Robuchon au Dôme doesn't provide an amuse-bouche course but does have a complimentary petit appetizer featuring Alaskan king crab. Here the crab is bathing in a graceful Vichyssoise cream soup decorated with croutons, delicate vegetables, and ginger jelly. Several pieces of airy chips scented with saffron are paired with the Vichyssoise. The cold Vichyssoise is creamy yet refreshing at the same time thanks to the crab's natural oceanic freshness. The saffron-scented chip then brings a totally opposite texture and warm spiciness to counter the whole. Before the first dish, a well-orchestrated symphony is already playing tutti in my mouth.

While I am still engulfed in the joy of enjoying the oceanic fantasy Vichyssoise, The waiter presents me with the most prestigious and enlightening creation of Joël Robuchon of all time — the Impérial caviar and king crab tartare refreshed with crustacean jelly. Surrounded by equally sized dots of cauliflower and parsley purée, the preparation of this dish requires an extreme amount of practice, patience, and labor. Regardless of the plating, the flavor on its own is fabulous enough to sweep me off my feet. The king crab caviar tartare exhibits extravagant umami that is refreshing yet pungent at the same time. The crustacean jelly continues to impart refreshing oceanic umami audaciously, which is soon softened by the cauliflower cream to bring impeccable balance to the flavor profile.



After the two cold appetizers comes a trilogy of warm dishes that not only delivers temperature but richer textures and flavors as well. The first one features morel mushroom, comté cheese ravioli, and fried suckling pig skin that imparts Italian-Cantonese fusion while the next Hokkaido scallop dish brings in south Asian taste via coconut and fresh coriander on top of its French culinary technique. The last one shifts us back to France when our palate encounters the classic roasted lobster bathing in the spicy bisque sauce. The lobster course soon sets the mood and prepares us to expect the traditional French beef course.



It seems that French chefs with no surprise would fancy delivering complex main courses together with several small side dishes. Alain Ducasse Macau, Maison Lameloise, and many others all do this, with no exception for Joël Robuchon.

I was expecting to taste the flamboyant beef Rossini which I had the luck to experience once in his Shanghai venue and would eager to enjoy once more. It is with regret to find that beef Rossini is currently off the menu, but they are presenting me with another beef course that may seem ordinary but soon blows my mind with unbelievable finesse.



At the center nestles a grilled wagyu beef presented with courtly ritual. The beef rubbed with spices and parsley is topped by a twilly of lightly fried potato and fried onion chips and encircled by a binary of shallot red wine purée and parsley purée. The dish is further surrounded by satellites of seasonal salad with vinaigrette, pomme soufflé, and chicken-mushroom bouillon accented with ginger and celery.



The remarkably tender wagyu exhibits a perfect balance between the umami of the flesh per se and the rich aroma of its unctuousness. The paired sauces and fried chips showcase rounded, delicate, elegant, and classical flavor profiles, bringing aristocratic temperament to the whole. As the beef part is rich enough to satisfy my palate, the side dishes are to counter the beef with refreshment. Regardless of the fact that the pomme soufflé is fried, it is unbelievably light in texture that resembles high-quality tempura.

After the luxurious main course comes the cheese course featuring Brillat-Savarin, 36-Month-Aged Comté, and Valençay, which are supplemented with fresh blackcurrant, dried apricot, blueberry jam, and walnut. Originated from Burgundy, the Brie-like Brillat-Savarin is a soft-ripened triple cream cow's milk cheese with at least 72% fat in dry matter and a white-crusted rind. Brillat-Savarin has the strongest milky creaminess and aroma among the three. Distinctive in its truncated pyramidal shape, Valençay is an unpasteurized goat-milk cheese with a fresh and citric taste as well as a layer of nuttiness obtained from aging. As for the Comté, its age gives it a fabulous strong fruity and spicy aroma.



The anticipation of sweets after savories always makes me nervous yet excited, and fortunately enough the mango dessert is totally worth the anticipation. The sugar sphere accented by mango imparts a delightful mellow sweetness that lingers on my palate with pure tropical fruitiness. With a remarkably light and thin texture, the coating sugar sphere blends smoothly into the inner rum ice cream, giving way to the creaminess and dark boozy aroma that dominates the finish. The light coconut mousse offers a velvety creaminess that sings in perfect harmony with the ice cream yet exhibits a refreshing and bright flavor profile to counter the rich-flavored medley.





Just as you think the curtain is about to fall when finishing the dessert, there comes again the luxurious trolley service, only it is even more flamboyant this time. Before the first trolley appears, the waitress gets us a pot of earl grey tea to enjoy together with the upcoming desserts.

The first trolley is a dessert trolley fully stocked with fancy traditional desserts, namely mille-feuille, religieuse, île flottante, baba au rhum, gâteau opéra, cherry pie, almond tart, chocolate tart, and cheesecake. Our waitress told us that we could pick as many as we desire, and we certainly would not give up the chance to try multiple traditional desserts at such a prestigious restaurant. Mille-feuille, religieuse, île flottante, and baba au rhum are the four we picked.



Next up is the ice cream and sorbet cart, which showcases six flavors of ice cream and sorbet, among which we select the all-time classic strawberry ice cream, the light creamy coconut ice cream, and the refreshing tropical passionfruit sorbet to clean the palate. The final trolley soon arrives with dozens of options of petit fours. We ask for papaya tart, lemon bonbon, and earl grey bonbon. It is almost like experiencing a complete afternoon tea service.



I could not imagine another meal as lavish as this one, maybe only with an additional cheese course could beat this record of mine. These four and half hours at Robuchon au Dôme is indeed a once-in-a-lifetime experience. "Fashion changes, but style endures," says Coco Chanel. The Robuchon team proves once more that classic French cuisine would never be beaten by Avant-garde cuisines and will keep shining for decades and decades.







